Quinn Reynolds

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Education

Honours Bachelor of Science, University of Toronto Expected June 2027

Computer Science Major, Mathematics Minor, Statistics Minor cGPA: 3.63/4.0 Last two years: 3.80/4.0

- **Relevant Coursework:** Neural Networks and Deep Learning, Intro to Machine Learning, Methods of Data Analysis, Multivariate Data Analysis, ML Engineering Capstone (in progress)

Research Interests

Machine learning for climate and environmental science; large language models for environmental data science; climate model downscaling with foundation models; multilingual safety and interpretability of large language models.

Publications

Under Review

[1] **Q. Reynolds**, D. Shore, V. Leos Barajas, T. Yoreh, M. Franklin. Quantifying organizational environmental action from web data and large language models. Under review at *Environmental Data Science*, 2026. arXiv:2609.16627.

Manuscripts in Preparation

[2] **Q. Reynolds**, M. Franklin. Robust downscaling of climate model projections with pretrained climate foundation models. *In preparation.*

[3] **Q. Reynolds**[*], U. Umut[*], X. L. Lin[*], C. Wan[*], D. Linkov. A multilingual safety-refusal benchmark for frontier language models and latent harmfulness signals in open-weight models. *In preparation.*

[*]Equal contribution.

Research Experience

Research Assistant, School of the Environment, University of Toronto September 2026 – Present

Supervisor: Dr. Tanhum Yoreh

- Continuing my USRA project by expanding the LLM framework for measuring environmental action in [1] beyond U.S. Jewish congregations to additional countries and religious traditions

Undergraduate Researcher, Department of Statistical Sciences, University of Toronto May 2026 – Present

Supervisor: Dr. Meredith Franklin

- Funded by an NSERC USRA (Summer 2026); first author of [1]
- Built a national database of 4,964 congregations and a 154,454-page web corpus, and compared keyword, semantic-retrieval and direct LLM classification against expert review
- Developing a robust approach to downscaling climate model predictions using large pretrained climate foundation models

Research Collaborator, Multilingual LLM Safety September 2026 – Present

Supervisor: Denys Linkov

- Building a robust multilingual safety-refusal testing benchmark for frontier language models
- Using the benchmark to extract a latent multilingual harmfulness signal from open-source models

Awards & Honours

NSERC Undergraduate Student Research Award (USRA) 2026
Dean's List Scholar, Faculty of Arts & Science, University of Toronto 2025, 2026
Silver T-Leaf Award, Varsity Blues Athletics, University of Toronto Awarded for 2024–25
Academic award for varsity athletes with a GPA of 3.5 or higher

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Calculus II, University of Toronto August 2025 – March 2026

- Led tutorials for groups of 10 to 30 students
- Fostered a collaborative learning community where all students were able to realize their potential

Industry Experience

Founding Engineer, Aspirare Semi November 2024 – Present

- Develop software to convert existing machine learning algorithms to run on Aspirare's custom silicon
- Lead low-level speed-testing software for assessing the viability of the Aspirare technology

Data Science Intern, Canadian Medical Protective Association May 2024 – August 2024

- Built tools and proof-of-concept pipelines for fine-tuning large language models on proprietary anonymized medical data, using PyTorch, Hugging Face, Ollama and LangChain
- Supported user testing of internally hosted LLMs
- Prepared AI technical reports and internal training material for senior leadership and stakeholders

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Java, C, C++
ML & LLMs: PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face, vLLM, LangChain, Ollama, Weights & Biases
Data: pandas, GeoPandas
Compute & Tools: Digital Research Alliance of Canada clusters, Modal, Git

Leadership & Activities

Varsity Rugby Athlete, University of Toronto September 2023 – March 2026